

User Guide — Vidya Setu Impact Dashboard

For Non-Technical NGO Staff

This guide will help you navigate the Impact Dashboard, understand what each chart means, and use the data to make better programme decisions.

Getting Started

Opening the Dashboard

1. Open your web browser (Chrome, Firefox, or Edge recommended)
2. Go to the dashboard URL provided by your IT team
3. The **Executive Summary** page loads automatically

What You See First

The dashboard has two main sections:

- **Left sidebar** — Navigation menu to switch between different views
 - **Main area** — Charts, numbers, and tables showing your programme data
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Understanding the Sidebar Navigation

Menu Item	What It Shows	When to Use
Executive Summary	Overall programme health at a glance	Your Monday morning check-in

Menu Item	What It Shows	When to Use
KPI Tree	How activities lead to outcomes	Monthly reviews and board presentations
Programme Progress	Target vs actual for each programme	Weekly programme management
Demographic Reach	Who we're reaching (gender, age, location)	Quarterly equity reviews
Cost-per-Impact	How efficiently we're using funds	Budget planning and donor reports
Trend Analysis	How things are changing over time	Strategic planning meetings
Data Quality	How reliable our data is	Operations reviews

Using Filters

At the top of every page, you'll see three dropdown filters:

Programme Filter

- **All Programmes** — Shows combined data across all 4 programmes
- Select a specific programme (e.g., "After-School Tutoring") to focus on it

Region Filter

- **All Regions** — Shows all 5 regions (South, North, West, East, Central)
- Select a specific region to see only that area's data

Period Filter

- **All Time** — Full 18-month dataset

- **Last 6 Months / Last 3 Months / Last Month** — Narrow the time window

Tip: Filters apply to ALL charts on the current page. They reset when you switch pages.

Page-by-Page Guide

1. Executive Summary

This is your **homepage**. It answers: *"How is the programme doing overall?"*

The Monday Number (Impact Score)

- The big number at the top is your **Composite Impact Score** (out of 100)
- It combines: learning gains (60%), retention (20%), and programme reach (20%)
- **Goal:** Keep this above 50. Below 30 needs immediate attention.

KPI Cards (the 4 coloured boxes)

Card	What It Means	Good Sign	Warning Sign
Active Beneficiaries	How many people are currently in our programmes	85%+ retention	Below 70% retention
Total Sessions	How many classes/workshops we've conducted	On track with targets	Below 50% of target
Avg. Reading Gain	How much reading scores improved	+5 points or more	Flat or negative
Cost per Beneficiary	How much we spend per person	Decreasing over time	Rising rapidly

Charts

- **Monthly Trend** — The area chart shows sessions (purple) and participants (green) over time. Both should be trending up or stable.

- **Programme Distribution** — The donut chart shows how our sessions are split across programmes.
 - **Activity by Region** — The bar chart shows which regions are most active.
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2. KPI Tree

This page shows **how our work creates impact**, step by step:

Activity (what we do)

- Output (what we produce)
- Outcome (what changes)
- Impact (why it matters)

How to read it:

- **Activity row:** Sessions held, hours invested, districts covered
- **Output row:** People trained, sessions completed
- **Outcome row:** Test score improvements, retention rates
- **Impact row:** Cost-effectiveness, overall improvement rates

Use this for: Board presentations, donor meetings, and understanding your Theory of Change.

3. Programme Progress

Shows **target vs actual** for each of the 4 programmes.

- **Progress bars** — Green means on track (>80%), yellow means watch (50-80%), red means behind (<50%)
- **Participants** — Total people reached by each programme
- **Total Cost** — Money spent on each programme
- **Monthly Stacked Bar Chart** — Shows how sessions are distributed across months and programmes

Action items:

- If a programme is below 50%, investigate why (staffing? logistics? demand?)
- Compare cost vs participants to see efficiency

4. Demographic Reach

Shows **who we're reaching** — critical for equity monitoring.

- **Gender Distribution** — Pie chart showing male/female/other split
- **Age Distribution** — Bar chart of age groups
- **Category-wise Outcomes** — Radar chart comparing reading/math/digital gains across General, OBC, SC, ST categories
- **District Table** — Performance metrics for each district

Key questions to ask:

- Are we reaching enough women/girls? (Target: >50%)
 - Are SC/ST beneficiaries getting equal outcomes?
 - Which districts need more attention?
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5. Cost-per-Impact

The **finance view** — shows how efficiently we're using money.

- **Total Investment** — Overall spending
- **Cost per Active Beneficiary** — What we spend per person who stays in the programme
- **Most Efficient Programme** — Which programme gives best value
- **By Funding Source** — Where our money comes from
- **Efficiency Table** — Detailed breakdown of cost/session, cost/participant, cost/outcome

For donor reports: Focus on the Cost-per-Outcome column — this is what funders care about most.

6. Trend Analysis

Interactive view with **4 tabs** to explore time-series data:

Tab	What It Shows
Sessions & Participation	Monthly sessions, participants, quality scores
Cumulative Growth	Total growth over the entire project period
By Programme	How each programme is trending independently
By Region	Regional activity patterns over time

Look for:

- Upward trends (good!) or downward trends (investigate)
- Seasonal patterns (e.g., drops during exam seasons)
- Regional disparities

7. Data Quality

Shows how **reliable and complete** our field data is.

- **Quality Score** — Percentage of records without issues (target: >90%)
- **Verification Rate** — What proportion of records have been verified
- **Issue Types** — Most common data problems
- **Field Worker Scorecard** — Individual performance of each field worker

Action items:

- Workers with quality score below 80%: schedule training
- Common issues (e.g., "missing_attendance"): update the data collection form
- Low verification rate: allocate more time for data review

Recommended Check-in Cadence

When	What to Check	Time Needed
Every Monday	Executive Summary → Impact Score + KPI Cards	5 minutes

When	What to Check	Time Needed
Every Week	Programme Progress → Are we on track?	10 minutes
Every 2 Weeks	Data Quality → Any problems to fix?	10 minutes
Monthly	Full review: Demographics + Trends + Costs	30 minutes
Quarterly	KPI Tree + Cost Analysis → Board presentation prep	1 hour

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Dashboard is loading slowly	Check your internet connection. Close other browser tabs.
Charts look empty	Try changing the filters to "All Programmes" and "All Time"
Numbers don't match my spreadsheet	The dashboard uses cleaned data. Check the Data Quality page for flagged records.
I can't see my district	Make sure the Region filter is set to "All Regions"

Glossary

Term	Meaning
KPI	Key Performance Indicator — a number that tells us how well we're doing
Beneficiary	A person who participates in our programmes
Retention Rate	The percentage of enrolled people who are still active

Term	Meaning
Cost-per-Impact	How much money it takes to achieve one unit of measurable change
Data Quality Score	How clean and complete our field data is
Baseline Score	A beneficiary's score BEFORE they joined our programme
M&E	Monitoring & Evaluation — the practice of tracking and assessing programme performance
Theory of Change	The logic model showing how our activities lead to impact

Vidya Setu Foundation — Impact Measurement Dashboard

NSS Open Projects 2026, Challenge 5.1

For support, contact your IT coordinator or the dashboard development team.